

Chapter 11

Admission, Transfer, and Discharge

Lesson 11.1: Admission, Transfer, and Discharge

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1. Identify guidelines for admission, transfer, and discharge of a patient.
2. Discuss the concepts of the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA).
3. Describe common patient reactions to hospitalization.
4. Identify nursing interventions for common patient reactions to hospitalization.
5. Discuss the nursing process and how it pertains to admitting, discharging, and transferring the patient.

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6. Discuss the nurse's responsibilities in performing an admission.
7. Describe how the nurse prepares a patient for transfer to another unit or facility.
8. Discuss discharge planning.
9. Explain how the nurse prepares a patient for discharge.
10. Identify the nurse's role when a patient chooses to leave the hospital against medical advice.

Guidelines for Admission

● Admission

- Entry of a patient into the health care facility
- Begins in the admissions department
- Patient will sign several forms
 - Admission routines that are efficient and show appropriate concern for the patient can ease anxiety and promote cooperation and positive response to treatment

HIPAA

- The Patient Self-Determination Act of 1991
 - Addresses the patient's right to refuse or accept medical treatment
- Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act
 - Addresses the privacy of all information received from the patient

Common Patient Reactions to Hospitalization

- The nurse can anticipate some common reactions
 - Fear of the unknown
 - Loss of identity
 - Disorientation
 - Separation anxiety
 - Loneliness

Nursing Interventions for Common Patient Reactions

- Have a warm, caring attitude and be courteous
- Show empathy
- Treat patients with respect
- Maintain their dignity
- Involve them in the plan of care
- Whenever possible, adjust hospital routine to meet their desires

Cultural Considerations

- Secure an interpreter when needed
- Assist the patient with maintaining cultural practices as much as possible
- Consider decision-making process of the family

Nursing Process

- Assessment
- Patient problem
- Expected outcomes and planning
- Implementation
- Evaluation

Nurse's Responsibilities

- When unit staff is notified that a new patient is being escorted to a room, the room should be made ready
- Any special equipment should be placed and ready when the patient arrives
- Greet the patient
- Give an orientation to the unit and the room
- Explain the hospital routine

Admitting Procedure on the Patient Care Unit

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- Check the ID band and verify the information with the patient
- Assess immediate needs such as pain, shortness of breath, or severe anxiety
- Introduce roommate, if present
- Jewelry, money, and medications should be given to the family to take home

Admitting Procedure on the Patient Care Unit

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- Once the patient is established in the room, the nurse should
 - Take the health history
 - Perform the initial assessment
 - The provider is notified when the patient has been admitted

Transferring a Patient

- The changing condition of a patient, whether improved or more critical, may require transfer either to another unit in the hospital or to another health care institution, such as a nursing home or rehabilitation hospital
- The patient transfer requires thorough preparation and careful documentation

Discharge Planning

- Systematic process of planning for patient care after discharge from the hospital
- Although discharge from a health care facility is usually considered routine, effective discharge requires careful planning and continuing assessment of the patient's needs during hospitalization
- Risk factors should be identified
- Discharge planning involves multidisciplinary action with participation by all members of the health care team, the patient, and the patient's family
- Referrals for health care services are considered

Discharging a Patient

- The discharge process

- Many hospitals have a form with written instructions and teaching documentation for the patient to sign and acknowledge understanding of the instructions
- These instructions serve as a guide for the patient to use at home

Discharge: Against Medical Advice (AMA)

- This is when a patient leaves a health care facility without a provider's order for discharge
- Notify the provider immediately
- If the provider fails to convince the patient to remain in the facility, the provider will ask the patient to sign an AMA form, releasing the facility from legal responsibility for any medical problems the patient may experience after discharge
- Do not detain the patient; this violates his or her legal rights